

Classroom Syllabus Outline for 1A SY26-27

Welcome Message

Aloha and Welina Mai to 1A! My name is Mrs. Mahina Yap, and I am so excited to be your child’s first-grade teacher. This year is going to be full of learning, community, and fun! In 1A, I hope to create a nurturing, united, inspiring, and faith-filled classroom where lifelong learners feel supported, challenged, and excited to grow. I am looking forward to getting to know all of you and working together to make your child’s first grade experience amazing.

Contact Information

- I can be reached at myap@starofthesea.org .
- I respond to emails between school hours Monday-Friday from 7:30 a.m.-3:30 p.m.
- You can also write me a note in your child’s Home-to-School Agenda book.
- Each Sunday you will receive an email with news/announcements and a weekly newsletter detailing what we will be learning for the upcoming week.
- Parent Pouch: A parent pouch will go home each Tuesday with important flyers from the school. Please check and remove all items and return your child’s parent pouch each Wednesday.
- We will also have two parent-teacher conferences this year that are scheduled for the first and third quarter.

Curriculum Overview

Religion

Quarter 1	Our Church Community
Quarter 2	Our Loving God
Quarter 3	God’s Son Jesus The Holy Spirit
Quarter 4	Jesus’ Church of Followers
Year-Long Learning Focus	Learning and reciting daily prayers, stories of Jesus, learning about God’s creations, learning and practicing proper church behavior for weekly Mass

Literacy

	Reading Workshop	Writing Workshop	Sounds to Spelling (Phonics)	Zaner-Bloser Handwriting
Quarter 1	Launching Readers Workshop and building good reading habits Sept: Reading folders go home	Launching Writer’s Workshop and Narrative Writing	letter names, CVC words, Digraphs (ch, th, sh, wh), floss rule ff, ll, ss, zz	Getting started and basic strokes
Quarter 2	Using decoding, comprehension, and fluency strategies to read simple texts	How to writing Writing to share my opinion on topics	S,R, and L Blends, Final blends (-mp,-nd) Glued sounds (ng, nk)	Writing letters and numbers
Quarter 3	Using our reading strategies to read	Fairy tales and realistic fiction	R-controlled words, long vowels	Writing words

	fairy tales and folk tales Learning about characters	Nonfiction booklets	w/magic ‘e’	
Quarter 4	Using decoding, comprehension, and fluency strategies to read non-fiction Poetry reading	Writing letters to persuade others Poetry writing	Long vowel teams (ee, ea, oa, oe, ue, ew) Long vowel i spelled y and igh	Applying Handwriting in the real world

Math, Science, and Social Studies

	Math Workshop	Science	Social Studies
Quarter 1	Measurement 2D and 3D shapes and their attributes Telling time to the hour and half hour Money Adding and subtracting within 5 fluently	Scientific process Matter and energy	Rights and responsibilities U.S. symbols
Quarter 2	Solving addition and subtraction word problems Adding and subtracting within 10 fluently	Objects and patterns in the sky	Families past and present Celebrations around the world
Quarter 3	Addition and subtraction facts to 20 using various strategies Working with addition and subtraction equations	Survival of living things (plants and animals)	Work and geography of a community
Quarter 4	Extending the counting sequence Place value Comparing two-digit numbers	Weather Engineering Design Process	May Day Geography (maps, globes, continents)

Daily Schedule

Please refer to the MSOS elementary bell schedule (a hard copy is included in your parent orientation folder) for exact times. Highlights of a typical day:

Morning Arrival and Prayer: Students settle in, morning meeting, prayer

Morning Language Arts Block: Reading, Writing, Phonics/Grammar, Handwriting

First Recess: Mid-morning snack and outdoor break

Math Block: enVision Math 2.0 lesson + math centers

Lunch and Lunch Recess: Midday

Afternoon Block: Social Studies, Science, or Religion (rotates by day).

Specials: P.E., Music, Art, Library, Chapel rotate on specific days - please check the weekly schedule or your monthly calendar of events for specific days and times.

Dismissal: Pickup procedures are in the family handbook. Please notify the office in advance for early pickups or changes.

Homework and Study Expectations

Following the MSOS guidelines of ~10 minutes per grade, first graders should expect roughly **10-15 minutes of homework per night**, plus daily independent reading. Homework is meant to reinforce (not introduce) what was learned in class.

- Each day your child will bring home their Home-to-School Folder and Home-to-School Agenda Book. Please check both the folder and initial the agenda book daily. Return to school each day.
- Your child’s homework log for the week will be glued into their Home-to-School Agenda Book.
- The homework log will indicate the homework each day and note important dates/reminders.
- Homework sheets will go home in their folder (Monday-Thursday). Homework sheets will be double-sided with math and language arts work. No homework is assigned on Fridays or during school breaks.
- Please remove all old paperwork daily. You will know I have checked homework if there is a star or happy face at the top.
- Monthly calendar and lunch schedule in sheet protectors. Please leave these documents in the folder.

Students will also be receiving reading folders with books at their reading level. These will be sent home starting in September. Reading folders go home on Monday with books for the week. Books are to be returned in the reading folder at the end of the school week in order to get a new set of books on Monday.

To support homework at home

- Set a consistent, quiet study time and place.
- Read the directions together, then step back and let your child work independently.
- Encourage your child to do their best work.
- If a task takes much longer than expected or your child is struggling, please let me know.

Classroom Procedures and Behavior Expectations

Our class has created a “classroom contract” that establishes how we’d like to feel while at school and the actions that should be taken to make everyone in our class feel like a part of our community. The students participated in a collaborative discussion in which we agreed upon the actions we wanted to see in the classroom contract. Each action fell under the umbrella terms of safety, attentiveness, respect, kindness, and doing your best. Each student is expected to follow the agreed upon expectations that were established during this conversation.

Other classroom expectations will be explicitly taught and demonstrated daily. Students are expected to work to high standards but are treated with warmth, respect, and fairness. I will contact you directly if your student is having any difficulties following classroom expectations.

1. Be Safe
2. Be Attentive
3. Be Respectful
4. Be Kind
5. Do your Best

When expectations are not met (in a supportive tone):

1. Reminder and reset
2. Reflection sheet or think time
3. Loss of a small privilege
4. Phone call home and, if needed, a family meeting with the principal

Assessment and Grading

Daily class work and homework will be checked for thoroughness, effort, and neatness. Writing assessments and class projects will be graded using rubrics. I will frequently be sitting down with students one-on-one to formally assess their academic progress. Throughout the school day I use informal, ongoing assessments to track student academic growth throughout the unit. I will then use summative assessments at the end of a unit or topic to measure student growth. Report cards are given at the end of each quarter and are graded using a 1 to 4 scale.

1-Beginning

- The student is beginning to understand the concept or skill
- Requires significant support and guidance
- Limited understanding or mastery of the topic

2-Developing

- The student demonstrates partial understanding or skill
- Needs occasional assistance or support
- Progressing but with notable gaps

3-Proficient

- The student meets grade-level expectations
- Demonstrates a solid understanding of concepts or skills
- Works independently with minimal errors

4-Mastery

- The student exceeds grade-level expectations
- Demonstrates a thorough understanding and can apply skills in new situations
- Work is consistently accurate and shows higher level thinking

Report cards are based on how your **child performs each quarter**. Grades are not reflected based on year-end benchmarks. Students also take a standardized assessment called STAR for early literacy and math in **August** and **May**.

Supplies and Materials

Provided by the school: textbooks, classroom manipulatives, math tools, and shared classroom technology.

Provided by the student: first-grade student supply list items (please see supply list on the MSOS website).

Students bring daily: Student backpack, Home-to-School Folder, Home-to-School Agenda book, a reusable water bottle, healthy snack.

Technology Use

Platforms used in this class:

- **FACTS/Beehively:** Grade portal and family communication
- **Individual iPads:** used in class for language arts and math practice
- **Educational sites:** Epic, Zearn, Freckle, Lalilo

Digital Citizenship: All device use follows the MSOS Technology Acceptable Usage Policy in the family handbook. First graders learn to use devices only for school work, keep passwords private, and tell an adult if anything on screen makes them uncomfortable.

Room Parent and Parent Volunteers

Room parents and parent volunteers at MSOS help support the PTG, the classroom teacher, and our students! Room parents gather information from the PTG and share that with their child’s classroom parents and teacher. There may be meetings that a classroom parent needs to attend with the PTG.

The duties of room parents may include...

- Helping the PTG organize school-wide events
- Getting volunteers for school-wide events
- Volunteering for school-wide events
- Organizing classroom activities
- Chaperoning field trips

How to Sign Up: Please email me if you’d like to help. All volunteers must sign a volunteer waiver.

Key Dates to Remember: Parent orientation, Parent-Teacher Conferences (Q1 & Q3), International Festival, Fall Festival, Christmas Program, Catholic Schools Week, May Day, and Semester Awards. Exact dates are on the school calendar and in weekly newsletters.

How To Support Your Child At Home

Families are our most important partners in helping students succeed. The routines and habits established at home provide the foundation for strong first-grade learners and make a meaningful difference in your child’s learning, confidence, and overall success. Children thrive when they have a consistent bedtime, arrive at school on time, read with an adult each day, complete homework, and talk with their family about their school day. Encouraging independence and responsibility through simple daily tasks—such as packing their backpack, caring for their belongings, and taking ownership of their work—helps build confidence and self-reliance. Equally important is maintaining open communication with your child’s teacher, creating a strong home-school partnership that supports every child’s growth. By working together to establish these routines, foster responsibility, and stay connected, we can help every first grader become a confident, capable, and successful learner.

Final Notes and Acknowledgment

Thank you for your partnership and support. Families play an essential role in helping students grow academically, socially, and emotionally, and I truly appreciate your commitment to working together throughout the school year. I look forward to partnering with you to make this a successful and rewarding year for your child.

Please visit our class website regularly at **starofthesea.org/classes** for important announcements, class pages, syllabi, unit materials, and other helpful resources.

Acknowledgment

After reviewing this syllabus, please email **myap@starofthesea.org** with the subject line:

"First Grade Handbook Reviewed — [Student Name]"

This confirmation lets me know the handbook has reached your family and that you’ve had an opportunity to review it together.

Mahalo for your partnership and support—I look forward to a wonderful year of learning together!